

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting July 17th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uWGcwQFDqAw
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Meeting Summary: Muny Redevelopment Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting of the Muny Redevelopment Commission to order on July 17th, 2025.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Miss Wagglely.
 - **Absent:** Not explicitly stated.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Miller (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted roll call and reviewed the agenda.
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved as presented by voice vote following a motion and second.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Mr. Dale moved to amend the previous meeting's memoranda to include omitted details regarding interlocal agreements (such as land bank discussions and sanitary district loan/grant questions). After failing to receive a second, that motion died. A subsequent motion to approve the memoranda as presented carried with a roll-call

vote: Mr. Bishop abstained, Mr. Dale voted “no”, Mr. Miller voted “yes”, Mr. Pilla voted “yes”, and Miss Waggley voted “yes”.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:46 Claims Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented the monthly claims, highlighting several notable bond payments and noting that he emailed explanations for higher-dollar claims in advance. Commissioners inquired about the use of multiple landscapers over the past month, which staff and commissioners explained was a distribution of properties among smaller contractors and a youth park program.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by roll-call vote (Mr. Bishop - yes, Mr. Dale - yes, Mr. Miller - yes, Mr. Pilla - yes, Miss Waggley - yes).
- **00:06:07 City & Executive Reports (Updates)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How (Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *High Point Station:* Green space work is underway across the street; economic development agreements are being finalized for 54 market-rate apartments and 15,000 square feet of commercial/restaurant space, including 85 total parking spaces. Awaiting final word on “Ready 2” funding.
 - *Muny Mall:* Awaiting final plans and “Ready Lilly” funding; TIF funds were previously released contingent upon demolition work starting within 6<U+2013>8 weeks. The mall’s property tax assessment has historically declined from \$35 million down to \$4.7 million.
 - *620 North Walnut Street:* Legal counsel is drafting a purchase agreement for this MRC-owned property to establish a multi-use building with student-led enterprises meeting school work-experience requirements.
 - *Hotels & Housing:* Ongoing discussions for 80<U+2013>100 room downtown hotels (preferring ground-up construction over retrofits), two developers aiming for 165 market-rate homes (\$300k+), and a 100-unit senior housing development near downtown.
 - *Market Trends:* Highlighted a Realtor.com article placing Muny at number five nationally for home price growth in 2025 due to affordability and demand.
 - *Tilpond & Skate Park:* Skate park commitments are finished. Tilpond contract has been awarded and work is managed by the city engineer (Adam Leech).
 - *Facade Grant:* Legal counsel is drafting the grant agreement, and communications teams are preparing website deployment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board action taken.

- **00:24:59 Muny Land Bank Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Howard reported that the land bank is transferring the first 11 properties in the Old West End to Intend next week, with ground breaking anticipated before the end of the year. The land bank submitted grant proposals to Centerpoint Energy and Ball Brothers Foundation, hosted an inheritance planning seminar, received a Robert Wood Johnson Foundation grant to study tax sale impacts (with a kickoff event August 8th), and is preparing for a quality-of-life survey with Ball State's third-year planning studio for the Industry and Whitley neighborhoods.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board action taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:28:37 Charlie Jameson (Taxpayer):** Asked which specific Ball State project has stalled, inquired about the status and construction timeline of the former YMCA development, and questioned the stance that the city/MRC washes its hands of projects like Tilpond simply because they do not directly own or construct them.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Commissioners discussed the timeline of the Cohen memorial placard (delayed via the state historical society until mid-2026).
 - Further debate occurred regarding public communication, project accountability, and whether public funds tied to projects like the YMCA and Tilpond warrant active public updates from staff.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote at **00:37:35** to meet again next month.